

ERP IMPLEMENTATION PROJECT

FreshFarm Organics

Organic Grocery | B2B Only – Vendors & Business Customers

Phase 1 – Understanding the Business

Company Profile & Business Requirements Brief



1. Business Overview

FreshFarm Organics is a certified-organic grocery business operating on a strict Business-to-Business (B2B) model. The company sources fresh fruits, vegetables and dairy products from organic farms and vendor partners and distributes them to registered business customers such as retail grocery chains, supermarkets, restaurants and institutional buyers through a dedicated online B2B ordering portal.

The business is built around three pillars: certified organic sourcing, farm-to-shelf traceability and reliable cold-chain logistics. Orders are placed exclusively through a web-based B2B portal where registered vendor/business accounts can browse the product catalogue, configure bulk quantities, choose a transport mode and pay for orders using a flexible 50/50 split-payment structure (50% advance to confirm the order, and the remaining 50% collected on delivery).

The company operates on a single-source-of-truth data mode i.e., all transactions across vendors, warehouses, business customers, payments, and reporting flow through one integrated ERP backbone (Odoo), enabling real-time visibility from procurement through to final collection and reporting.

2. Products / Services

FreshFarm Organics deals in certified organic produce across three primary categories, sold in bulk units (kg, litre, box, crate, or piece) suited to B2B ordering:

- **Fruits**

Organic Bananas, Apples sold by weight with quality-grade tags such as “Best Seller” and “Premium Grade”

- **Vegetables**

Fresh Spinach, Tomatoes, Organic Carrots, Carrots - marketed with freshness and certification tags such as “Certified Organic,” “Farm Fresh,” and “Bulk Available”

- **Dairy**

Full-Fat Farm Milk - tagged “Cold Chain Only” and requires temperature-controlled handling throughout.

Alongside the physical product catalogue, the company effectively offers logistics-as-a-service to its B2B customers through three transport tiers:

- **Cold Chain Transport**

Temperature-controlled (2–8°C), mandatory for dairy and leafy greens; next-day delivery window.

- **Standard Freight**

Ambient freight for hardy produce; the most cost-effective option; 2–3 day ETA.

- **Express Delivery**

Same/next-day priority dispatch with a guaranteed 24-hour delivery window.

Supporting services include live order tracking, proforma and GST-compliant tax invoicing, and a split-payment gateway offering UPI/QR, NEFT/RTGS, and Corporate Card options.

3. Customers

FreshFarm Organics serves registered business buyers only — there is no direct-to-consumer (B2C) channel. Typical customer profiles include:

- Grocery and supermarket chains sourcing certified organic produce for retail shelves.
- Restaurants, cafés, and institutional kitchens that require consistent, traceable bulk supply.
- Wholesale distributors and APMC-market-based traders (e.g., business buyers operating out of yards such as the Navi Mumbai APMC yard).

Each customer accesses the platform through a secure B2B login (business email and password) and is identified in-system by company name and an authorized contact person — typically a procurement manager placing bulk orders on behalf of their organization. Customer relationships are managed as leads that progress into confirmed opportunities and repeat sales orders within the CRM.

4. Suppliers

The upstream supply base consists of organic farms and certified vendors, onboarded through a formal B2B vendor-leads process. Key aspects include:

- Vendors and farmers are captured as leads with complete business details, contact persons, and organic-certification documentation.
- Vendors are qualified before engagement, and procurement follows a formal cycle: RFQ to vendors → compare & select → purchase order creation → PO confirmation → status tracking.
- Incoming goods undergo quality inspection, lot/batch and expiry capture, and putaway into central or regional warehouses before being marked available for sale.

This structured onboarding and receiving process ensures every unit sold can be traced back to its originating farm or vendor and certification record — the foundation of the company’s “farm-to-shelf traceability” promise.

5. Departments

The business is organized into the following functional departments, each of which maps to a distinct module in the ERP solution:

Department	Core Responsibility
Procurement	Vendor onboarding, RFQs, purchase orders, and vendor relationship management.
Warehouse / Inventory	Goods receipt, quality inspection, lot/expiry tracking, and multi-warehouse stock management.
Sales (B2B)	Lead-to-opportunity conversion, quotations, sales order confirmation, and inventory reservation.
Website / B2B Portal	Vendor login, product catalogue, order configuration, request-for-quote, and order placement.
Delivery / Logistics	Picking, packing, quality check, cold-chain/standard/express dispatch, and delivery status updates.

Department	Core Responsibility
Accounting / Finance	Invoicing, vendor bills, split-payment collection, bank reconciliation, and financial reporting.
Employees / HR	User roles, access rights, departmental structure, attendance, and payroll administration.
Reporting & Dashboards	Executive, sales, inventory, and finance dashboards for real-time, data-driven decisions.

6. Business Challenges

- **Perishability and spoilage risk** – fruits, vegetables, and dairy have short shelf lives, making lot/expiry tracking and FEFO (First-Expiry-First-Out) stock rotation critical; any lag in visibility leads to wastage.
- **Cold-chain dependency** – dairy and leafy greens require continuous temperature control (2–8°C); a break anywhere in transport or storage risks product quality and compliance.
- **Manual, disconnected processes** – without an integrated system, procurement, inventory, sales, delivery, and finance data can live in silos, causing mismatched stock counts, delayed invoicing, and poor demand visibility.
- **Complex payment collection** – the 50/50 split-payment model (advance + balance on delivery) requires accurate tracking of partial payments, proforma invoices, and final tax invoices for every order — a manual process is error-prone at scale.
- **Traceability and certification compliance** – as an organic-certified business, every batch must be traceable back to its source farm; maintaining this manually across multiple vendors and warehouses is difficult.
- **Multi-warehouse coordination** – managing stock visibility, reorder rules, and putaway consistently across central and regional warehouses adds operational complexity.
- **Scalability of vendor and customer onboarding** – as the B2B customer and vendor base grows, lead capture, qualification, and account management need a structured, repeatable process rather than ad hoc handling.

7. Growth Objectives

- **End-to-end process integration** – unify inventory, procurement, sales, delivery, invoicing, and payments on a single ERP platform (Odoo) as one source of truth.
- **Improve real-time inventory and expiry visibility** – reduce stockouts and spoilage through better lot/batch tracking and reorder automation.
- **Strengthen farm-to-shelf traceability** – reinforce the organic-certification promise as a competitive differentiator with B2B buyers.
- **Reduce spoilage and wastage** – through FEFO stock rotation, IoT cold-chain monitoring, and AI-driven expiry alerts.
- **Accelerate procurement and delivery cycles** – streamline RFQ-to-PO and order-to-delivery timelines to serve business customers faster.
- **Ensure accurate invoicing and collections** – automate proforma and tax invoicing around the 50/50 split-payment model to improve cash flow predictability.
- **Enable data-driven decisions** – roll out executive, sales, inventory, and finance dashboards for real-time, informed decision-making.
- **Adopt Industry 4.0 capabilities** – progressively layer in IoT cold-chain sensors, AI demand forecasting, AI expiry alerts, and blockchain-based traceability for organic certification.
- **Expand the B2B customer and vendor network** – scale the lead-to-opportunity pipeline to onboard more certified vendors and business buyers without proportionally increasing manual overhead.

Note

This document forms Phase 1 of the FreshFarm Organics ERP implementation project, which simulates a real-world ERP engagement covering enterprise systems, business process design, ERP architecture, Odoo configuration, and digital transformation. Subsequent phases will build on this business understanding to define process maps, system requirements, and the detailed Odoo (ERP) solution design.